

Consolidated

HEAD – TALENT ACQUISITION · STRATEGIC TRANSFORMATION

Building a scalable hiring system for the ₹5,000 Cr journey

A practical Talent Acquisition strategy to hire faster, reduce attrition, and make hiring a key driver of business growth.

Revenue ₹3,000 → ₹5,000 Cr

~1,000 hires/yr

Attrition 45% → below 25%

Time-to-hire 50+ → 30 d

01 · OUR VISION

Moving from reactive hiring to a proactive system

Currently we hire only after a role opens. We will shift to planning hiring ahead of demand — based on the store-expansion roadmap — and keep pre-screened candidates ready. The focus moves to hiring quality talent that stays, not simply filling roles quickly.

🎯 OUR FOUR FOCUS AREAS

- ✓ **Speed** — talent pipelines + AI + clear timelines. Goal: hire within 30 days.
- ✓ **Quality** — structured interviews + an honest role preview. Goal: new hires staying past 90 days.
- ✓ **Cost-efficiency** — more referrals, fewer agencies, AI support. Goal: cost per hire ₹4,500.
- ✓ **Employer brand** — a consistent social presence + the Apple brand advantage. Goal: higher offer acceptance.

The first 90 days — a phased plan

Sequenced deliberately — a broken process cannot be scaled. First fix the basics, then build the system, then demonstrate results.

0–30 Assess & Stabilise

- Review open roles, time taken at each stage, sources of hire & attrition by store.
- Move all hiring onto a single applicant tracking system (ATS).
- Dedicated team for the 100 new-store roles.
- Relaunch the employee referral programme with prompt payouts.

31–60 Build the System

- Standardised interview kits + culture-fit scorecards.
- Maintain pre-screened talent pipelines for high-volume roles.
- Redesign onboarding: ready from Day 1, with 30/60/90-day check-ins.
- Introduce AI screening + chatbot; reduce agency dependence.

61–90 Demonstrate Results

- Early wins: time-to-hire ~40 days; fewer offer declines.
- Launch employer-branding content.
- Go live with a real-time hiring dashboard for leadership.
- Present the full 12-month roadmap.

03 · 12-MONTH PLAN

The 12-month roadmap, in four quarters

Each quarter builds on the previous one. We complete a quarter's foundation (its gate) before moving to the next.

Q1 Foundation

→ ATS fully adopted · standardised interviews · referral programme · onboarding v2. **Gate: ATS adoption >90%.**

Q2 Speed

→ AI screening at scale · pipelines for top 5 roles · stage-wise timelines. **Gate: time-to-hire ≤35 days.**

Q3 Quality & Brand

→ Employer-branding push · leadership-hiring playbook · career paths live. **Gate: attrition <35%.**

Q4 Optimise

→ Reduce cost & agency use · plan hiring in advance. **Gate: 30 days · ₹4,500 · agency <4%.**

04 · TEAM & STRUCTURE

A team built to hire 1,000+ people a year

A central team owning tools, data & standards, supported by recruiters embedded within each business for speed and closeness. About 13–15 people in total.

Volume / Retail

~820/yr

Store & service hiring.

Corporate & Enterprise

~160/yr

B2B · Education · Corporate.

Leadership & Niche

IN-HOUSE

Senior hiring, handled in-house.

TA Ops & Analytics

SUPPORT

Systems · AI · dashboards.

Employer Brand

PIPELINE

Ongoing talent sourcing.

 **Team sizing:** a volume recruiter handles ~120–150 hires/year and a corporate recruiter ~40–60. So ~6–7 recruiters, 3–4 sourcers, 1 analytics lead, 1 branding lead + 4 team leads.

05 · FASTER HIRING

Reducing time-to-hire from 50+ to 30 days

Hiring is slow because we start from scratch for every role and wait too long for manager feedback. The fix: keep candidates ready and run the stages in parallel, with clear timelines.

50+

TODAY (DAYS)

~36

PIPELINES

30

TARGET

20

STORE ROLES

🎯 HOW WE ACCELERATE HIRING

- ✓ **Use pre-screened pipelines** for high-volume roles → fill in days, not weeks.
- ✓ **Run stages in parallel** — screening, interview & scheduling together; AI screens 24x7.
- ✓ **Set stage timelines** — manager feedback in 2 days, offer within 5 days.
- ✓ **Instant scheduling** via chatbot for store roles; ready panel for leadership.
- ✓ **Reduce offer declines 28% → under 12%** with a quicker process & clear compensation upfront.

06 · REDUCING ATTRITION

Reducing attrition from 45% to below 25%

Most exits happen in the first three months — about 20% within 45 days, and ~70% of all exits within 90 days. Retention begins on the day of hire.

45%

TODAY

~35%

12 MONTHS

<25%

24 MONTHS

🎯 OUR THREE-PART APPROACH

- ✓ **A · Hire right** — assess culture fit, give an honest role preview, and raise referrals to 40%+ (they stay longer).
- ✓ **B · Onboard well** — ready Day 1, assign a buddy, review at 30/60/90 days. One owner for first-90-day retention.
- ✓ **C · Retain** — clear growth path (Advisor → Senior → Team Lead → Store Manager) + early warning signals when someone may leave.

AI drives speed — and reduces cost by half

AI handles the repetitive work — sourcing, screening, scheduling and candidate queries. Cost falls mainly through more referrals, fewer agencies, and fewer re-hires.

Technology stack — phased

- **Phase 1** — full ATS + live dashboards (the data foundation).
- **Phase 2** — AI screening + a WhatsApp/chat assistant for high-volume roles.
- **Phase 3** — AI sourcing + early attrition warning signals.

 **COST: ₹9,000 → ₹4,500**

- ✓ **Referrals 20% → 40%+** — the lowest-cost channel, with better retention.
- ✓ **Agencies 9–10% → under 4%** — bring sourcing & leadership hiring in-house.
- ✓ **AI automation** — lower cost per candidate at high volume.
- ✓ **Lower attrition** — each avoided replacement saves a full hiring cost + training time.

 **A positive cycle:** referrals stay longer → attrition falls → fewer re-hires → recruiters focus on growth rather than replacement → agency budget shifts to lower-cost, higher-quality channels.

How we measure progress — and manage risk

METRIC	NOW		TARGET
Time-to-hire	50+ d	→	30 d
Cost per hire	₹9,000	→	₹4,500
Referral hiring	20%	→	40%+
Agency spend	9–10%	→	<4%
Offer declines	28%	→	<12%
Attrition	45%	→	<25%
90-day retention	baseline	→	90%+

Key leading indicator: **90-day retention** — it signals attrition months before the annual figure moves.

⚠ RISK → RESPONSE

⚠ **Aggressive competitor hiring** → stronger brand + quicker offers + referrals.

⚠ **Speed vs quality** → talent pipelines + structured assessment.

⚠ **Attrition not falling** → prioritise onboarding & the first 90 days.

⚠ **Slow system adoption** → make ATS mandatory; link to manager reviews.

⚠ **Sudden demand** → 100-hire buffer + ready pipelines.

📊 **Review rhythm:** a weekly operational review · a monthly strategic review with the CEO/CHRO.

OUTCOMES & THE ASK

The same ~1,000 hires, now driving real growth

We cannot reach ₹5,000 Cr while 45% of our people keep leaving. By fixing retention and speed together, the same hiring delivers genuine growth — faster, more cost-effective, and built to last.

30 days

TIME-TO-HIRE

<25%

ATTRITION

₹4,500

COST PER HIRE

₹5,000 Cr

GROWTH ENABLED

